Zaki Pugh-Fradot

West Kelowna, BC · +1 236 457 3069 · zakipughfradot@gmail.comLinkedIn · Portfolio · GitHub · itch.io Canadian & French citizen · EN/FR/ES · Available to relocate within one month

SUMMARY

I am a computer science graduate from UBC (high distinction) who loves making games, telling stories, and watching people enjoy them. I have worked across a variety of different fields, with experience in both backend engineering and community management. I also have many small projects under my belt: I was the primary game designer on multiple games and the dungeon master for two long-form homebrew Dungeons & Dragons campaigns. I am proficient in balancing mechanics, creating worlds and everything within, leading teams of people to bring these visions to life.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BA Computer Science | UBC Okanagan | 85% overall (high distinction)

Relevant coursework: Game Development, Human-Computer Interaction, Narrative Design & Dystopian Fiction, Mythological Worldbuilding, Cultural Studies, Software Engineering, Artificial Intelligence.

High School Diploma | La Châtaigneraie (Ecolint), Switzerland | 2023

EXPERIENCE

Community Playtest & Player Support | Kotoko Inc. (Contract) | 2026–Present

- Run live playtest sessions for a live-service title: field player questions in real time, de-escalate conflicts, and keep the testing environment constructive.
- Deliver structured feedback on assigned mechanics, identifying usability problems and balance issues.
- Act as the reporting line between players and the development team, isolating recurring bugs and writing them up so they are actionable.
- Provide day-to-day operational support for live-service features.

Freelance Game Designer | Self-Employed | 2023–Present

- Lead designer on a no-turn card game built on automatic trigger conditions and a refill-based tension system. Running balance iteration and card-condition readability passes with a small team.
- Built and shipped a live standings overlay for a Riftbound tournament organiser: pulls standings from the event API, renders into OBS as a browser source, one-click launcher, no manual data entry between rounds.
- Designed and shipped three Unity games, Duck Guns (arcade shooter), Pablo May Die (GMTK Game Jam 2024 roguelike), Spaghetti Western (GMTK Game Jam 2025 narrative puzzle).
- Own mechanics, UI, and narrative systems end to end in Unity/C#.

Games Club President (formerly Vice President) | UBC Okanagan | Sept 2024–May 2026

- Coordinated weekly meet-ups for 20+ students across two academic years, progressing from VP to President.
- Organised special events and public programs, handling scheduling, logistics, and turnout.

Backend Developer | Lookout | 2025 |

- Designed the testing suite for the backend system on a team of 8+; reviewed pull requests and tested teammates' code.

DESIGN

Dungeon Master | Two long-form homebrew D&D campaigns | 2023–Present

- Run a six-player table weekly; original settings and pantheons, with the world bible maintained in Kanka.
- Design encounters, factions, and multi-session arcs, then rebalance from table feedback.

BattleSim | Personal tool suite

- Built a suite of D&D encounter-prep tools around a web-based combat simulator, with a statblock-to-JSON converter and a statblock draft generator, to cut prep time for DMs.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design: systems and mechanics balancing · narrative design · worldbuilding and lore architecture · rapid prototyping · tabletop campaign and homebrew design

Community & ops: live playtest facilitation · player support · conflict de-escalation · bug triage and reporting · event coordination · team leadership

Tools: Unity, C#, Git/GitHub, Unreal Engine, Kanka, Twine, Articy

Languages: English, French, Spanish